AI PRODUCT MANAGEMENT 2 · DETAILED COURSE

Responsible AI, Safety and Governance

Managing the ethical, legal and security risks of AI products so they can be launched and trusted.

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CHAPTER 18

Responsible AI, Safety and Governance

Managing the ethical, legal and security risks of AI products so they can be launched and trusted.

Responsible AI Fundamentals

Principles of fairness, reliability, safety, privacy, transparency, accountability and inclusiveness.

Responsible AI principles include fairness, reliability, safety, privacy, transparency, accountability and inclusiveness. Turn each principle into a testable requirement for your product.

AI Ethics

Weighing benefits and harms to people and society when designing and deploying AI.

Ethics weighs the benefits and harms to people and society when designing and deploying AI. Ask who could be harmed and who has not been consulted.

Data Privacy

Respecting what personal data is collected, how it is used and who sees it.

Respect what personal data is collected, how it is used and who can see it. Collect only what the feature needs and explain it clearly to users.

Data Protection

Technical and organisational safeguards such as encryption, access control, retention limits and minimisation.

Safeguards include encryption, access control, retention limits and data minimisation. Retention limits mean deleting data when it is no longer needed.

GDPR

The EU regulation giving people rights over personal data and imposing duties on organisations processing it.

The EU regulation gives people rights over their personal data and places duties on organisations that process it. It applies to products serving EU residents, even when the company is based elsewhere.

India's Digital Personal Data Protection Act

India's 2023 law on processing digital personal data, based on consent and notice, with obligations for data fiduciaries; confirm current rules with counsel.

India's 2023 law regulates digital personal data, based on consent, notice and obligations for data fiduciaries. Check current rules and their implementation timeline with legal counsel.

AI Security

Protecting models, data, prompts and tools from misuse and attack.

Protect models, data, prompts and tools from misuse and attack. Security reviews should cover the model provider, the data flow and the tools the model can call.

Data Leakage

Sensitive information exposed through prompts, outputs, logs or training data.

Sensitive information can leak through prompts, outputs, logs or training data. Redact personal data before it reaches a model or a log, when the feature does not need it.

Prompt Injection

Malicious text that tries to override instructions or trigger unwanted actions, including through retrieved content.

Malicious text tries to override instructions or trigger unwanted actions, including text hidden in retrieved documents. Separate instructions from data and limit the tools available to the model.

Jailbreak Risks

Prompts designed to bypass safety rules; test regularly and layer defences.

Jailbreak prompts try to bypass safety rules. Test regularly with known patterns, and layer defences rather than relying on one filter.

AI Bias

Systematic unfairness from skewed data, labels or design.

Bias is systematic unfairness from skewed data, labels or design choices. Audit outcomes across groups, not only overall accuracy.

Fairness

Ensuring outcomes are equitable across groups, measured with agreed metrics.

Fairness means outcomes are equitable across groups, measured with agreed metrics. There is no single fairness metric, so choose the one that matches the harm you are guarding against.

Explainability

Giving understandable reasons for outputs, especially for high-stakes decisions.

Explainability gives understandable reasons for outputs, especially for high-stakes decisions such as credit. Users and regulators may need the reasons, not only the score.

Transparency

Being clear about when AI is used, its limits and how data is handled.

Be clear about when AI is used, its limits and how data is handled. Users calibrate trust better when they know what the system is.

Human Oversight

Meaningful human review, override and accountability for important decisions.

Meaningful human review, override and accountability for important decisions. A human who rubber-stamps every output does not provide real oversight.

AI Guardrails

Input and output filters, policy checks and permission limits that constrain behaviour.

Input and output filters, policy checks and permission limits constrain behaviour. Guardrails work best as several layers rather than one rule.

Content Moderation

Detecting and handling harmful or disallowed content from users and models.

Detect and handle harmful or disallowed content from users and models. Define the policy first, then build tools to enforce it, with an appeals path.

Access Control

Limiting who and what can reach data, tools and models, based on role and need.

Limit who and what can reach data, tools and models, based on role and need. Apply the same rules to the AI feature as to the underlying data.

AI Governance

Policies, roles, review processes and standards for responsible AI across the organisation.

Governance sets policies, roles, review processes and standards for responsible AI across the organisation. It answers who approves an AI use case and who is accountable when it fails.

AI Risk Management

Identifying, rating and mitigating AI risks, using frameworks such as NIST AI RMF.

Identify, rate and mitigate AI risks. Frameworks such as the NIST AI Risk Management Framework give a structure for this work.

Enterprise AI Governance

Central oversight of AI use cases, vendors, data and approvals across a large organisation.

Central oversight of AI use cases, vendors, data and approvals in large organisations. It prevents teams from adopting unapproved tools with customer data.

Regulatory Compliance

Meeting laws and standards that apply to your market and use case, such as the EU AI Act, GDPR and sector rules.

Meet the laws and standards that apply to your market and use case, such as the EU AI Act, GDPR and sector rules. Compliance requirements shape product design, so involve legal early.

AI Incident Management

Detecting, triaging, fixing and learning from AI failures, with communication and post-incident review.

Detect, triage, fix and learn from AI failures, with clear communication and a post-incident review. Blameless reviews find systemic causes.

Responsible AI Product Launch

A checklist before launch covering risks, testing, approvals, user disclosure, monitoring and rollback.

A pre-launch checklist covers risks, testing, approvals, user disclosure, monitoring and rollback. Launch only when every item has an owner and a status.

Summary of terms

Term	Meaning
Responsible AI Fundamentals	Principles of fairness, reliability, safety, privacy, transparency, accountability and inclusiveness.
AI Ethics	Weighing benefits and harms to people and society when designing and deploying AI.
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Data Protection	Technical and organisational safeguards such as encryption, access control, retention limits and minimisation.
GDPR	The EU regulation giving people rights over personal data and imposing duties on organisations processing it.
India's Digital Personal Data Protection Act	India's 2023 law on processing digital personal data, based on consent and notice, with obligations for data fiduciaries; confirm current rules with counsel.
AI Security	Protecting models, data, prompts and tools from misuse and attack.
Data Leakage	Sensitive information exposed through prompts, outputs, logs or training data.
Prompt Injection	Malicious text that tries to override instructions or trigger unwanted actions, including through retrieved content.
Jailbreak Risks	Prompts designed to bypass safety rules; test regularly and layer defences.
AI Bias	Systematic unfairness from skewed data, labels or design.
Fairness	Ensuring outcomes are equitable across groups, measured with agreed metrics.
Explainability	Giving understandable reasons for outputs, especially for high-stakes decisions.
Transparency	Being clear about when AI is used, its limits and how data is handled.
Human Oversight	Meaningful human review, override and accountability for important decisions.
AI Guardrails	Input and output filters, policy checks and permission limits that constrain behaviour.
Content Moderation	Detecting and handling harmful or disallowed content from users and models.
Access Control	Limiting who and what can reach data, tools and models, based on role and need.

AI Governance	Policies, roles, review processes and standards for responsible AI across the organisation.
AI Risk Management	Identifying, rating and mitigating AI risks, using frameworks such as NIST AI RMF.
Enterprise AI Governance	Central oversight of AI use cases, vendors, data and approvals across a large organisation.
Regulatory Compliance	Meeting laws and standards that apply to your market and use case, such as the EU AI Act, GDPR and sector rules.
AI Incident Management	Detecting, triaging, fixing and learning from AI failures, with communication and post-incident review.
Responsible AI Product Launch	A checklist before launch covering risks, testing, approvals, user disclosure, monitoring and rollback.

Practice exercise: Run a risk review for one AI feature covering privacy, bias, injection and misuse. Assign an owner and mitigation to each risk.

Self-check

1. Explain Responsible AI Fundamentals in two sentences to a non-technical stakeholder, then say what you would measure for it.
2. Explain Explainability in two sentences to a non-technical stakeholder, then say what you would measure for it.
3. Explain Responsible AI Product Launch in two sentences to a non-technical stakeholder, then say what you would measure for it.

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- AI Governance and Responsible AI: Risk, safety and compliance.
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